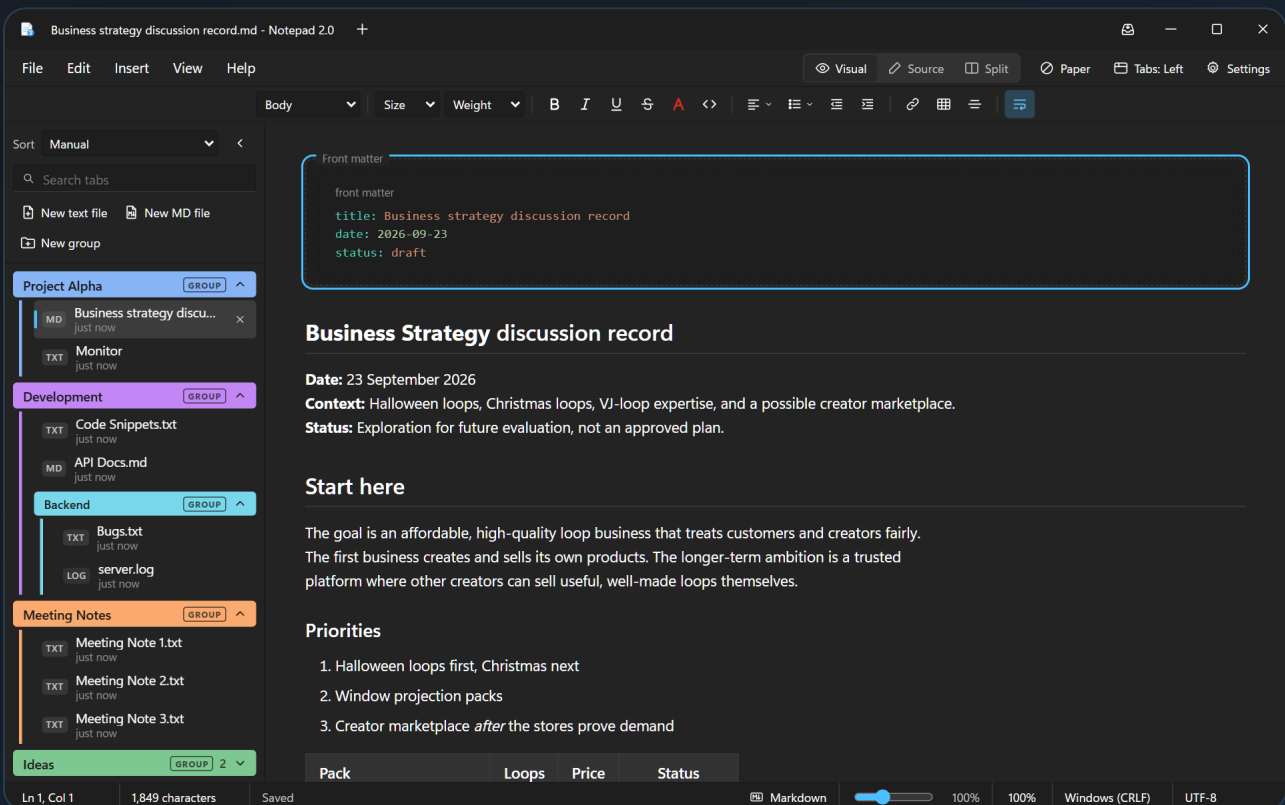


Notepad 2.0

The Windows 11 Notepad you know, with file groups, a Markdown editor you type straight into, several windows, paper styles and a Quick Note one keypress away.



Install, then your first five minutes

Setup takes a few seconds, installs for your user only (no admin password), and doesn't need a restart.

Install

- Run **Notepad 2.0_0.1.0_x64-setup.exe** (or the **.msi**).
- Open **Notepad 2.0** from the Start menu. The first time, it offers a short tour.
- To open your **.txt** and **.md** files with it, or to replace **notepad.exe**, see *Windows integration* on page 7.

Seven things to try

1

New text file: **Ctrl + N**

Start typing. It autosaves until you choose where to keep it.

2

New Markdown file:

Ctrl + Alt + N

It opens in the Visual editor. Use the toolbar for headings, colours, lists and tables.

3

Make a file group

Right-click a tab, then *New file group...*
Drag more files onto it.

4

Change the layout

Click *Tabs: Top* (top right) for tabs on top, a sidebar, or a slim rail.

5

Pick a paper

Click *Paper* for Code, Lines or Grid, and set a page margin.

6

Tear off a window

Drag a tab outside the window. It opens in a new window.

7

Quick Note: **Win + Alt + N**

From anywhere. Type, click away, it's saved.

?

Take the tour

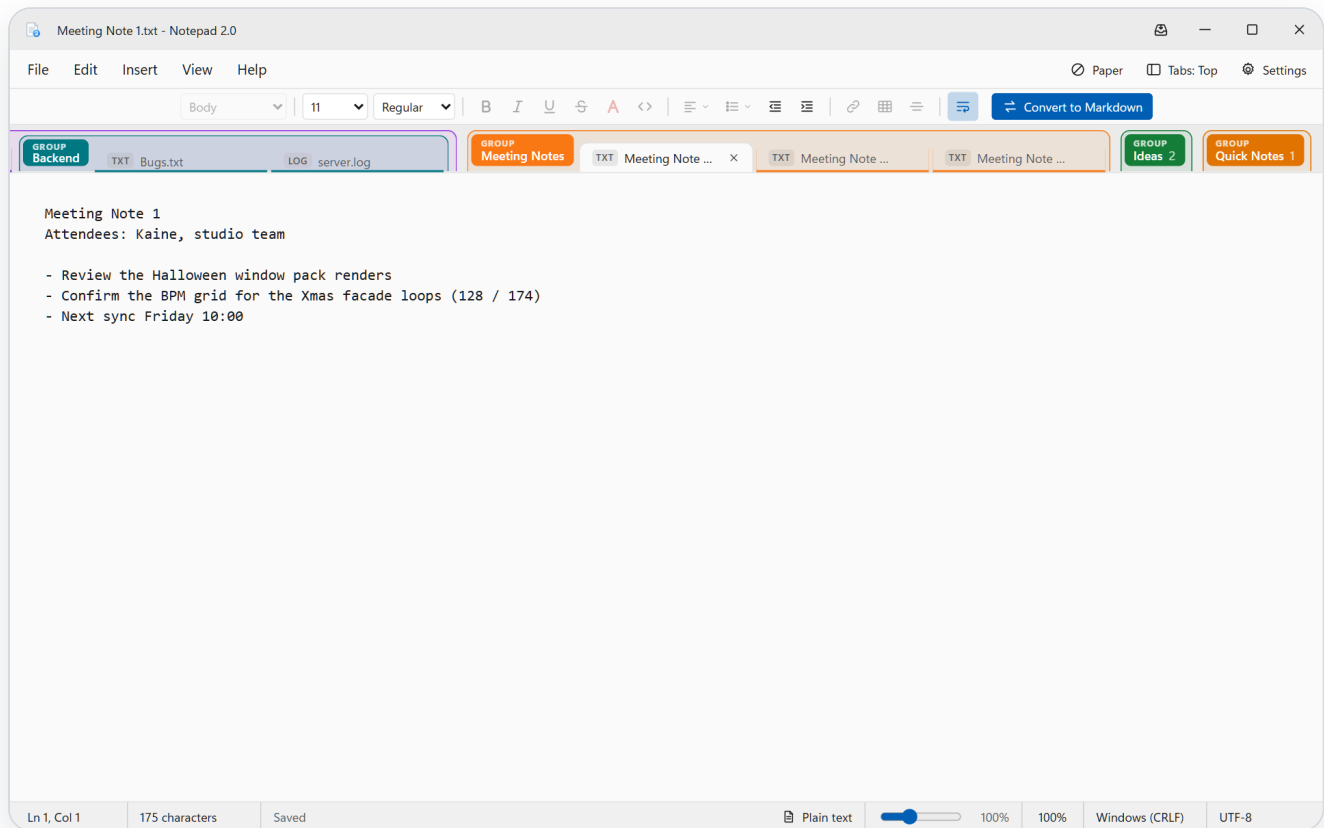
Help → *Startup guide* spotlights each part of the window in 13 steps.

Nothing is ever lost. Untitled notes and Quick Notes save as you type. Opened files save with **Ctrl + S** like Notepad, but unsaved edits survive a crash or reboot and come back with a banner.

THE BASICS

It's still Notepad

Same menus, same shortcuts, same instant start. Plain text stays plain, and a file you haven't changed is never altered by a single byte.



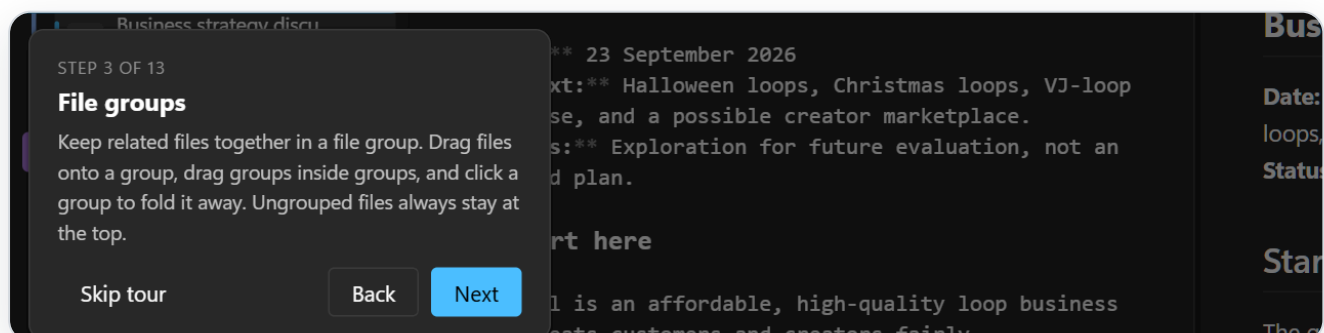
Light theme, tabs on top, a plain .txt file. On a text file only the tools plain text can hold are active, and a **Convert to Markdown** button appears.

Everything Notepad does

- Find, Replace, Go to line, Print
- Date and time with **F5**
- UTF-8, UTF-16 and ANSI; CRLF or LF, shown in the status bar
- Font picker, word wrap, text zoom

Look and feel

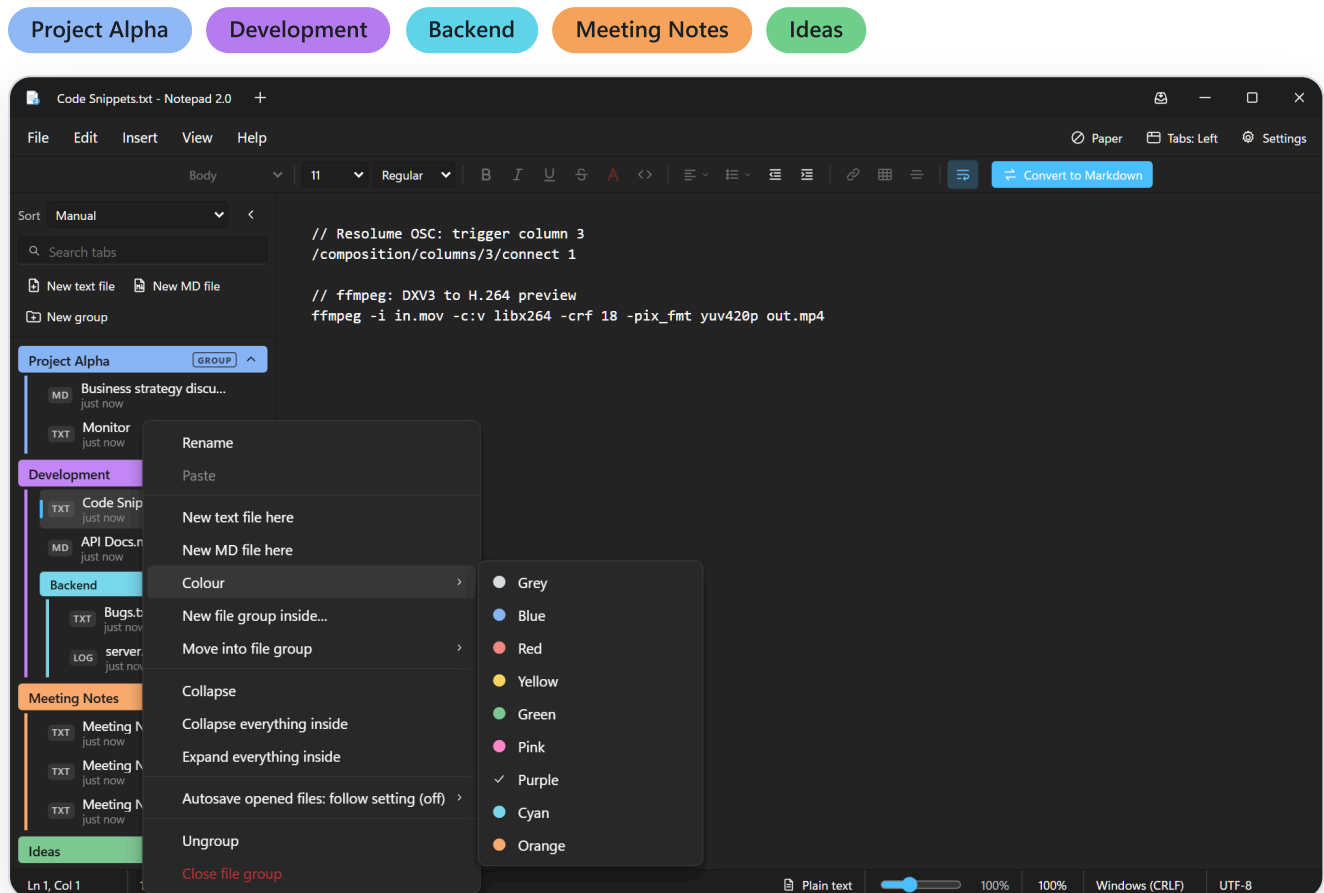
- **Light, Dark or System** theme
- **Interface size** 75–150% from the status-bar slider. Hold **Shift** and press **+** / **-** outside the text to nudge it.
- Text zoom (**Ctrl** **+** / **-**) is separate



New here? *Help* → *Startup guide* is a 13-step spotlight tour of the window, offered the first time you start.

File groups, tabs and the sidebar

Keep related files together in coloured groups. Groups can sit inside groups, and ungrouped files always stay at the top.



Right-click a group to rename it, add files, change its colour, nest a group inside, collapse everything, or set autosave for the whole group.

Layouts

- **Tabs on top**, joined to the page
- **Sidebar** on the left: drag its edge to resize
- **Rail**: a slim list of groups

Sort

Manual, Date modified, Date created, Name A–Z or File type. Sorting is a view: your own order is kept.

File actions

- **Rename in place**: double-click or **F2**. Saved files are renamed on disk, never over an existing file.
- **Duplicate, Copy, Paste** into another group. Copies are named *Name (2).ext*.
- **Open in File Explorer**
- Right-click → **Colour** tints a single tab

Markdown you can type into

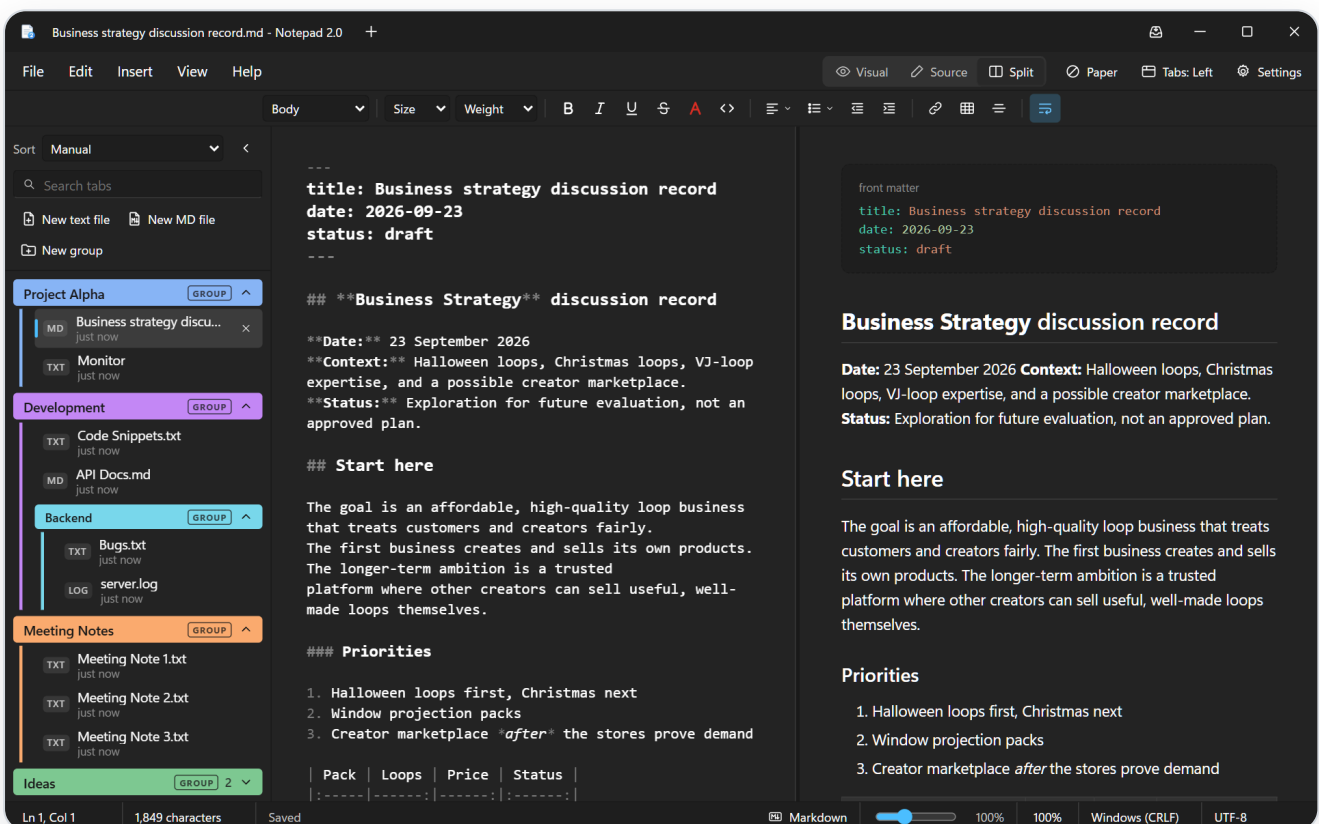
Three views of the same file. Switch with the buttons at the top right, or press **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **V**.

VIEW WHAT IT'S FOR

Visual A true WYSIWYG editor. Type straight into the formatted document, like a word processor.

Source The raw Markdown, with syntax highlighting.

Split Source on the left, a live preview on the right: tables, task lists, footnotes, front matter, maths, Mermaid diagrams, highlighted code.

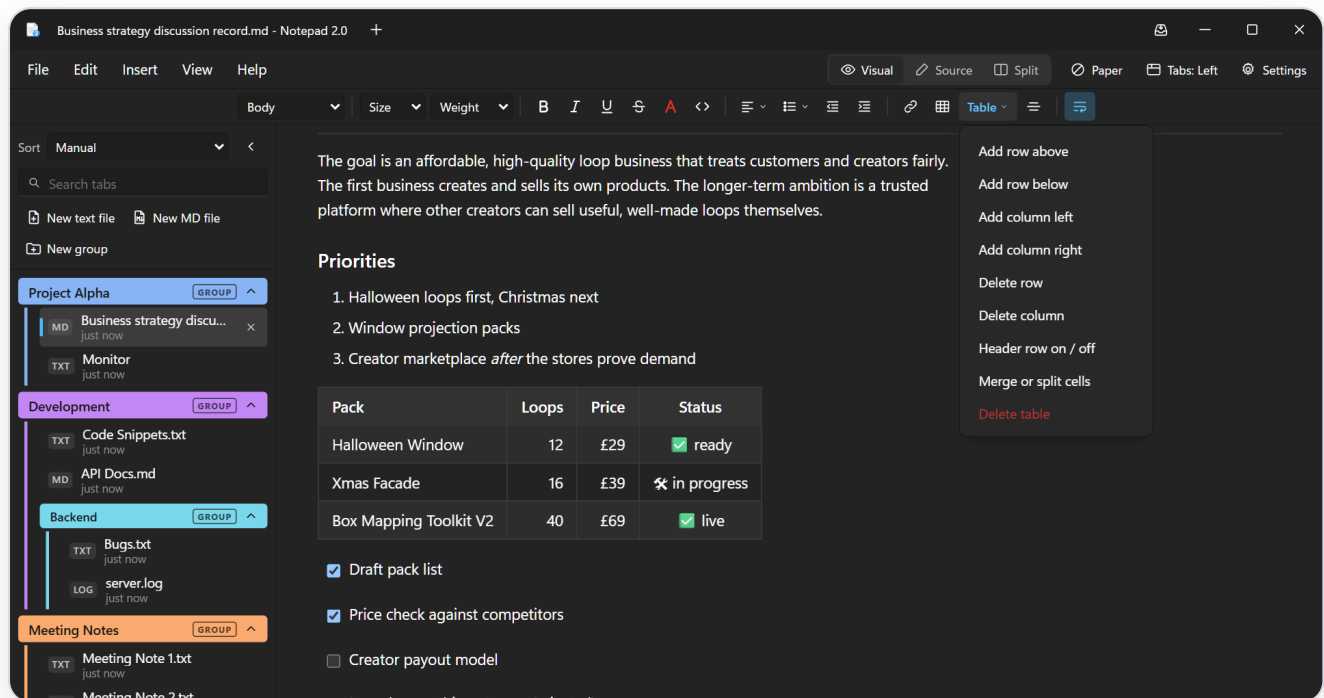


Split view. Formatting Markdown can't express (underline, colour, alignment) is saved as the small HTML tags GitHub understands, so files look right there too.

Locked blocks. Front matter, maths, Mermaid and other raw HTML show as locked blocks in Visual so nothing is mangled. Double-click one to edit it in Source.

Tables, inserts and paper

Click inside a table and a **Table** menu appears on the toolbar.



Add or delete rows and columns, toggle the header row, merge or split cells. Drag borders to resize. Cells hold formatted text and lists.

Insert menu

Page break, line break, image, table (with a size picker), link (**Ctrl** + **K**), horizontal line, date and time.

Paper

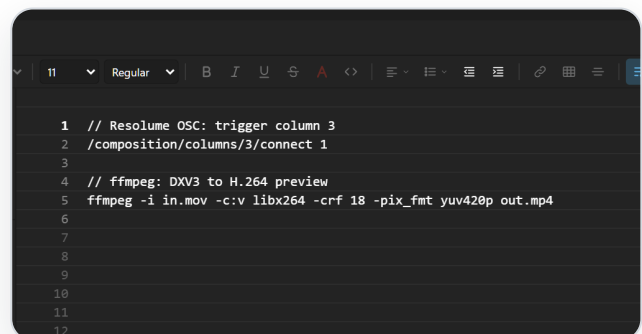
None A clean page

Code Line numbers down the whole page

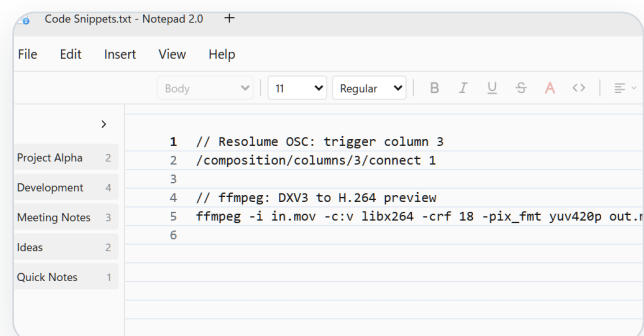
Lines Ruled writing paper

Grid Graph paper

For every tab or per tab. **Page margin** (0–200 px) works in every view.



Code paper

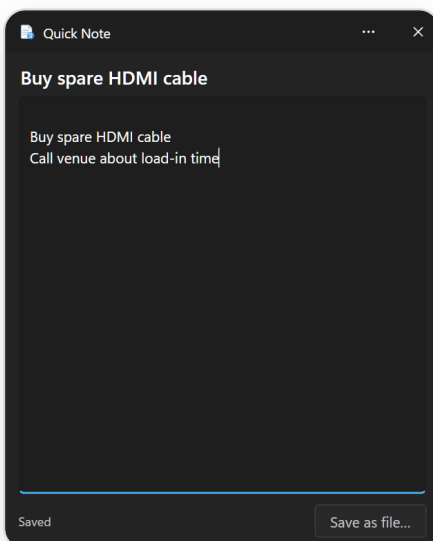


Lines paper, with the slim rail

Windows, Quick Note and dictation

Several windows

- **Drag a file, group or sub-group outside the window:** it opens in a new window at the pointer.
- **Drag between windows** to move items, dropped exactly where you let go.
- **Close a window** and its files move into the window you used last. Nothing is lost.
- **Restart** and every window comes back where it was, the last one you used in front.
- Opening a file that's already open elsewhere brings that window forward.



Quick Note

Press **Win + Alt + N** anywhere, or click the tray icon. A small always-on-top note pops up above the tray and saves as you type. Your Quick Notes collect in a **Quick Notes** group in the main window.

Dictate

Click the **microphone** button in the Quick Note to dictate with Windows voice typing (the same as **Win + H**). Speak, and your words appear in the note.

Windows integration

In *Settings* → *Windows integration*:

- Default app for .txt and .md
- **Replace notepad.exe** (one admin prompt, reversible)
- *Edit with Notepad 2.0* in File Explorer's right-click menu
- Start with Windows, quietly in the tray

Uninstalling removes all of these.

Keyboard shortcuts

Every Notepad shortcut works as before. These are the ones worth learning.

FILES AND TABS

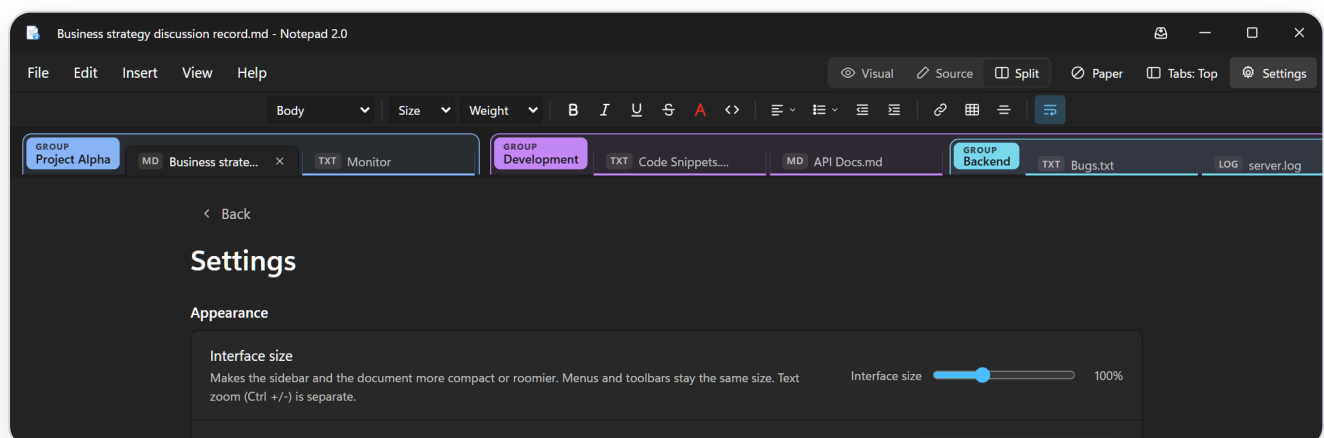
Ctrl + N	New text file
Ctrl + Alt + N	New Markdown file
Ctrl + O	Open
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save as
Ctrl + Alt + S	Save all
Ctrl + W	Close tab
Ctrl + Shift + W	Close window to the tray
Ctrl + Shift + G	New file group
F2	Rename the current file
Ctrl + P	Print
Win + Alt + N	Quick Note, from anywhere

EDITING AND VIEW

Ctrl + F	Find
Ctrl + H	Replace
Ctrl + G	Go to line
F3 / Shift + F3	Find next / previous
F5	Insert date and time
Ctrl + K	Insert link
Ctrl + Shift + V	Visual → Source → Split
Ctrl +] / [	Indent / outdent a list item
Ctrl + + / - / 0	Text zoom in / out / reset
Shift + + / -	Interface size (outside the text)
Win + H	Dictate

Where your notes are kept

- Files you open or save live **wherever you put them**, as ordinary .txt and .md files.
- Untitled notes, Quick Notes, groups, window layout and settings live in **%APPDATA%\Notepad2**. Paste that into the File Explorer address bar to open it.



Settings: interface size, theme, font, tabs and groups, saving, Quick Note and Windows integration.